



(Courtesy: JALIN/SPR)

professional competency to manage and scale up innovations; advocacy is not sufficiently evidence-based, efficiency isn't high on the agenda and most shy away from evaluating the effectiveness of interventions. Only a few organisations have struck the balance between cooperating with the government and remaining adversarial.

Voluntarism has its share of concerns. A few socially-committed people are turning to the voluntary sector but many remain uninterested, partly because it doesn't offer attractive pay packets. It also has to do with the sector's failure to professionalise and present itself as a career choice. Funding is another hurdle. Accepting grants from the government undermines their independence. While foreign donations are use-

Rs 6,000

crore were
granted to
NGOs by the
Government
in 2006-07

21,000

is the number of
NGOs registered
under the Foreign
Contribution and
Regulation Act

vigilance and public pressure are essential.

Fresh thinking is needed to rejuvenate the spirit of voluntarism and agencies have to be more professional. Civil society also needs to develop a deeper understanding of the role of voluntarism in making India secure for all. In the ultimate analysis, India needs a new maturity to deal with voluntary public action.

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ful, they can't be a long-term source. Sustainability has to come from corporate and individual contributions. But genuine funding by corporate India is yet to take off. Many NGOs are also viewed with suspicion, their activities seen as political. But governments must recognise that public